



Notes

Aug 11, 2026

Agent Ecosystem Working Group 1: Enterprise Agent Architecture - MACH Alliance

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Attachments  Agent Ecosystem Working Group 1: Enterprise Agent Architecture - ...

Meeting records  Transcript

Summary

Group planning centered on hackathon logistics, archetype definitions, and a new product catalog generator demonstration.

Hackathon Planning and Strategy

Terminology for agent patterns shifts to archetypes for the upcoming technical guide. The team decided against making the introductory course a mandatory requirement for hackathon participation.

Archetype Prototype Updates

Development continues on 5 distinct archetypes, with members assuming ownership of different workflow models. Interoperability remains the priority over prescribing specific programming languages or tools.

Catalog Generator Demonstration

A new tool simplifies product image creation by batching items and enforcing style guidelines through large language models. This resource generates consistent data outputs for various integration platforms.

Decisions

Needs Further Discussion

- **Harness vs agent definition deferred** The definition of "harness" versus "agent" remains unresolved and is deferred for a future working group discussion.

Aligned

- **Terminology updated to archetype** The group decided to standardize on the term "archetype" instead of "bucket" to better describe agent patterns.

- **Build Lab prioritizes learning** The Build Lab event scope is set to prioritize learning and experimentation over the mandatory completion of individual agent projects.
- **Prep work is recommended, not mandatory** Participation prerequisites for the Build Lab will be encouraged as a recommendation rather than enforced as a hard entry requirement.
- **Open access prototype strategy adopted** The group adopted a strategy for prototypes that prioritizes open-source accessibility without mandating specific technology stacks or languages.

We've **updated the Decisions section** using your feedback.

Let us know what you think: [Helpful](#) or [Not Helpful](#)

Next steps

- ☐ [Rebecca] Update Slack Access: Invite Patrick and Paul to the workspace to provide proper access.
- ☐ [Rebecca, Tim] Coordinate Build Lab: Determine tools and logistics for the upcoming event and share findings in the Slack channel.
- ☐ [Everett] Release Prototype 5: Refactor and upload the latest code for the cross organization boundary agent archetype to the repository.
- ☐ [Tim] Create Prototype 2: Build a simple workflow demonstration using a Large Language Model within a deterministic process.
- ☐ [Scott] Demo Catalog Tool: Present the product catalog generator to the team to assist with sourcing item imagery for demos.
- ☐ [The group] Discuss Harnesses: Add the harness debate to the agenda for a future working group session.
- ☐ [Tim Benniks] Execute Tasks 1 and 2: Manage and build out the first and second archetypes.

- ☐ [Rebecca Lyus] Contact Doug and Ryan: Follow up with them to determine if they need assistance with their assigned tasks.
- ☐ [Rebecca Lyus] Manage Slack Access: Ensure all participants are added to the dedicated communication channel.
- ☐ [Everett Zufelt, Patrick Bosek] Discuss Archetype Structure: Coordinate an offline meeting to review how the archetype buckets are divided.
- ☐ [Patrick Bosek] Contribute Archetypes: Develop and add new versions to the archetypes buckets.
- ☐ [Everett Zufelt, Scott Trafford] Release Demo Tool: Collaborate to make the image generation tool available for broader use.

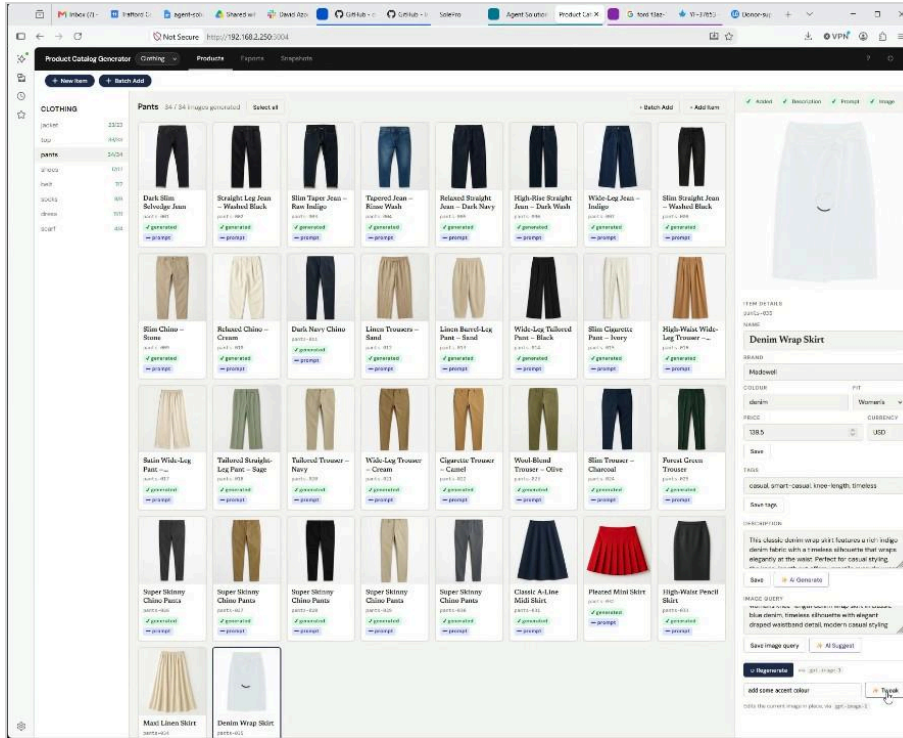
Details

Did the screenshots in this section make your notes [better](#) or [worse](#)?

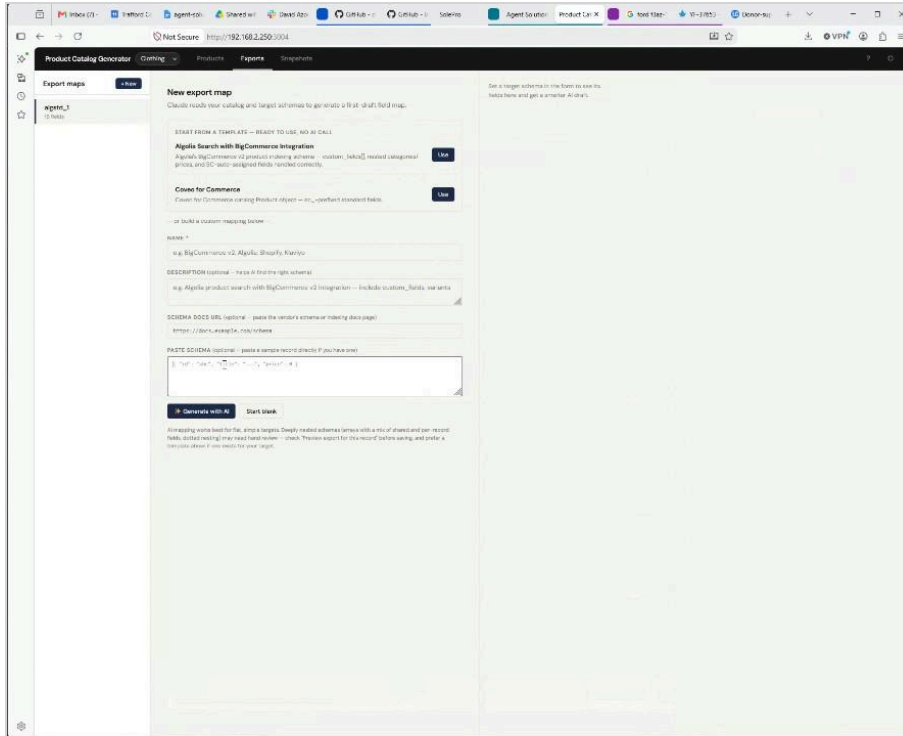
- **Meeting Opening and Introductions:** The meeting began with introductory pleasantries followed by a round of introductions for new participants. Tim Benniks, Rebecca Lyus, and Everett Zufelt facilitated, noting the participation of new members Patrick Bosek and Paul Sims ([00:02:17](#)). Attendees were directed to the existing GitHub repository to review previous meeting notes and progress ([00:02:53](#)).
- **Project Goals and Definitions:** Everett Zufelt provided background on the working group, which formed three or four months ago to demonstrate agent patterns for enterprise integration ([00:04:48](#)). The group is shifting terminology from "buckets" to "archetypes" to better describe when specific patterns should be implemented. A 50-page technical reference guide is expected to be published within two to three weeks ([00:06:11](#)).
- **MACH X Build Lab Roadmap:** The group discussed the upcoming "build lab" hackathon taking place at MACH X in Amsterdam at the end of September. The goal is to provide a "hackathon-in-a-box" resource set for others to teach and use agent archetypes ([00:07:11](#)). This event serves as a deadline for the group's current work ([00:08:17](#)).

- Participant Backgrounds:** Attendees introduced their professional backgrounds: Everett Zufelt (Orium), Tim Benniks (Content Stack), Rebecca Lyus (MACH Alliance), Paul Sims (Equal Experts), Patrick Bosek (Heredo), Puneeth (Injust Labs), and Scott Trafford (Trafford Consulting) ([00:09:15](#)). Each participant shared their current role and interest in agentic workflows ([00:10:07](#)).
- Agenda Strategy:** Everett Zufelt proposed prioritizing the demonstration of Scott Trafford's product catalog generator before discussing administrative planning for the upcoming hackathon, a suggestion with which the group agreed ([00:16:38](#)).
- Hackathon Logistics and Scheduling:** The group categorized the hackathon into three segments: logistics/admin, surrounding content, and packaged prototypes ([00:18:21](#)). Rebecca Lyus confirmed the event date is September 29th and provided details on the venue, the "yellow room," with a schedule running from 1:00 PM to 4:30 PM ([00:20:06](#)).
- Communication Channels:** Patrick Bosek and Paul Sims requested access to the MACH Alliance Slack workspace. Rebecca Lyus agreed to handle the invitations to ensure they receive relevant communications ([00:21:10](#)).
- Hackathon Scope and Tooling:** Discussions regarding the "build lab" emphasized that the primary goal is experimentation and learning rather than completing a functional agent within the three-hour timeframe ([00:22:39](#)). Tim Benniks and Rebecca Lyus took the action to coordinate on the specific tools and infrastructure that will be provided to attendees for these builds ([00:24:25](#)).
- Preparation and Prerequisites:** Patrick Bosek suggested requiring participants to complete an introductory course before the hackathon to establish a baseline of knowledge ([00:26:14](#)). While the group liked the idea of a suggested course, they decided against making it a mandatory "price of admission," opting instead to frame it as a recommendation to maximize attendee value ([00:27:01](#)).
- Administrative Planning Action Items:** Tim Benniks and Rebecca Lyus agreed to collaborate offline to finalize logistics, communications, and tooling requirements, planning to share an update with the wider group via Slack within the next week ([00:28:48](#)).

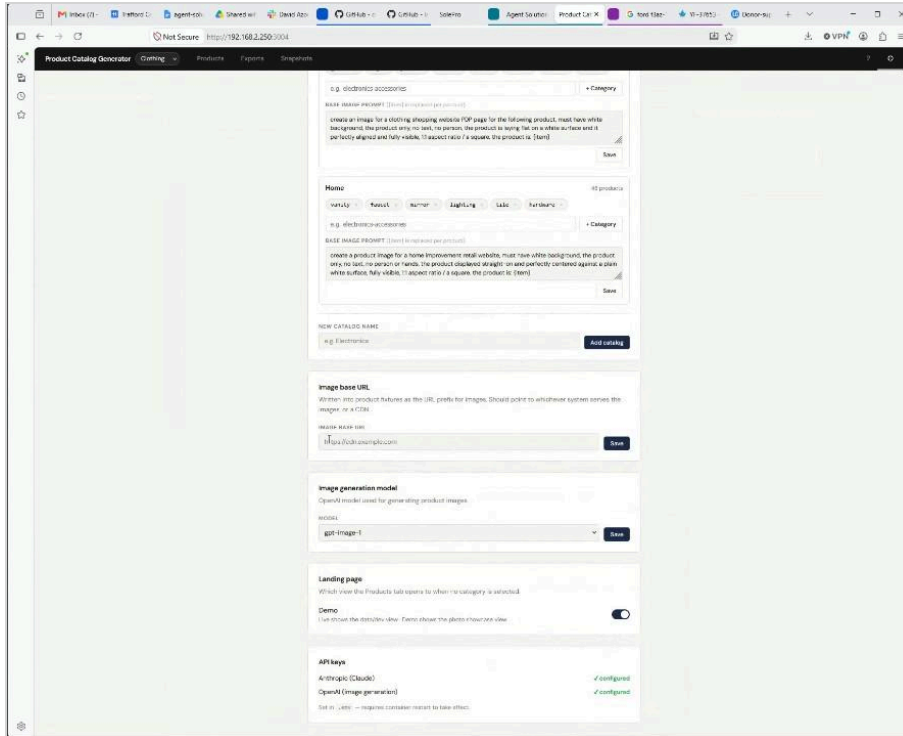
- **Status of Archetype Prototypes:** Everett Zufelt reported that the Archetype 5 prototype (cross-organizational agent) is functional and undergoing cleanup ([00:31:15](#)). Danielle is working on Archetype 4, while Tim Benniks committed to taking ownership of Archetypes 1 and 2, which focus on simpler, non-agentic LLM-driven workflows ([00:32:20](#)).
- **Defining Agent Nomenclature:** A discussion arose regarding definitions, specifically distinguishing between "agents" and "harnesses" ([00:33:12](#)). Patrick Bosek offered to contribute an open-source agent built for release notes, with the group agreeing to revisit terminology debates in future sessions ([00:33:54](#)).
- **Technology Standards:** Everett Zufelt suggested that the group should not be overly prescriptive about programming languages or specific tools for the prototypes, emphasizing interoperability and open access over specific tech stacks ([00:35:43](#)).
- **Prototype Ownership Assignments:** Rebecca Lyus agreed to follow up with Doug and Ryan regarding the status of Archetype 3 ([00:36:41](#)). Patrick Bosek expressed interest in contributing to the archetypes and planned to coordinate with Everett Zufelt offline to understand the differences between the current categories ([00:38:04](#)).
- **Scott Trafford's Catalog Generator Demo:** Scott Trafford demonstrated a catalog generator designed to solve the issue of finding high-quality product images for demos. The tool allows users to create categories, batch-add items with style descriptors, and generate images using an LLM ([00:39:12](#)). It includes a feature to "tweak" specific images by modifying existing outputs, which provides better consistency than generating fresh images from scratch ([00:41:53](#)).



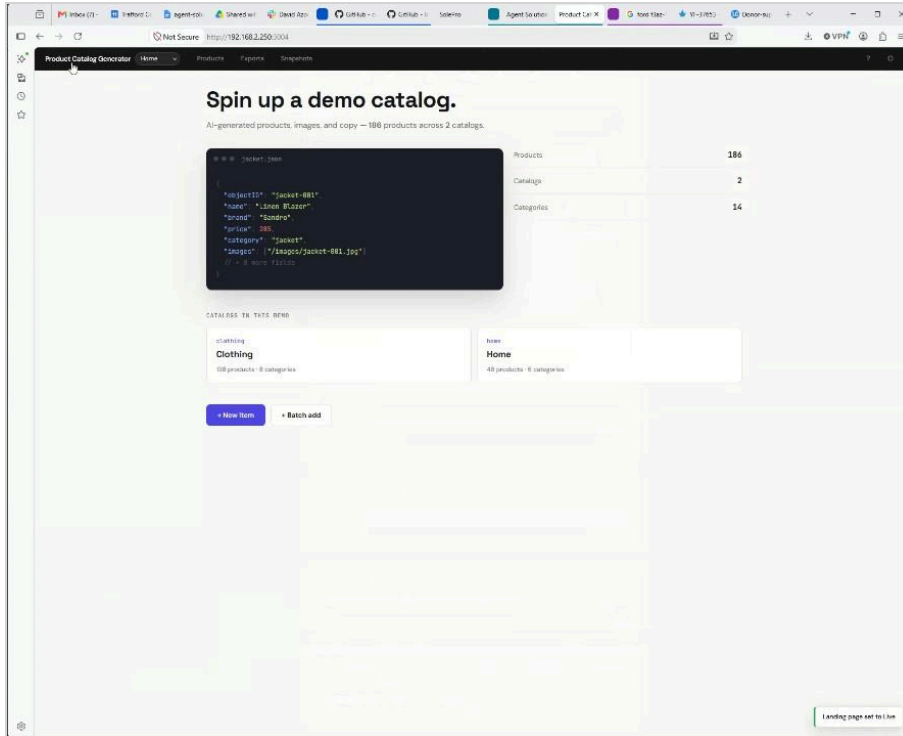
- Advanced Features of the Catalog Generator:** Scott Trafford explained that the tool uses base prompts to enforce brand guidelines, such as white backgrounds or specific aesthetics (00:42:54). Users can export the generated data using custom schemas, making the tool adaptable for different platforms like Algolia (00:44:54).



- **Future Roadmap for the Generator:** Tim Benniks suggested enhancing the tool to provide API endpoints rather than just zip file exports, and discussed the possibility of integrating with Cloudinary for hosted image storage. Scott Trafford noted that these features could be implemented as the tool is further developed ([00:46:33](#)).



- **Cost and Technical Considerations:** The group discussed the cost-effectiveness of the tool, with Scott Trafford noting that a batch of testing cost under \$25 ([00:49:36](#)). Everett Zufelt mentioned researching aggregators like F.AI for accessing multiple audio, video, and image models via a single API key ([00:50:28](#)).
- **Closing Remarks:** The meeting concluded with a discussion on the tool's readiness for production-level pitches, with Scott Trafford confirming that users could add their own API keys for personal use ([00:54:07](#)). The group agreed that the project is a valuable community resource, and contributions via pull requests are welcome ([00:54:55](#)).



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Transcript

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00:00:00

Scott Trafford: Good morning. How are you?

Rebecca Lyus: I'm good, thank you. And yourself?

Scott Trafford: Good.

Everett Zufelt: Good

Rebecca Lyus: Yes. Good morning.

Everett Zufelt: morning.

Scott Trafford: Hello.

Rebecca Lyus: I thought we wouldn't have you today. Everett as you're on leave, aren't you?

Everett Zufelt: I just love agents though,

Rebecca Lyus: Ah,

Everett Zufelt: Rebecca.

Rebecca Lyus: so keen.

Scott Trafford: No. Tell the truth. You love me.

Everett Zufelt: Well, there's that, too. There's that. Hopefully, we have some others join in here.

Rebecca Lyus: Yep.

Everett Zufelt: I do appreciate that it is August though. So, we'll see.

Rebecca Lyus: Yes. I I'm very much looking forward to

Scott Trafford: There we go.

Rebecca Lyus: autumn.

Scott Trafford: Oh, no. Really?

Rebecca Lyus: I can't stand the heat.

Scott Trafford: Oh, I love summer.

Rebecca Lyus: I I am a grumpy autumn person.

Scott Trafford: Uh, I'm I'm a barefoot shorts person.

Rebecca Lyus: No, I I am blankets even in the hottest point of summer. I like fuzzy boots.

00:01:12

Rebecca Lyus: All right,

Patrick Bosek: That sounds uncomfortable.

Rebecca Lyus: that look great. All right.

Tim Benniks: Hello everyone.

Scott Trafford: Hello.

Rebecca Lyus: Hello.

Tim Benniks: I think through circumstances of hard work and holiday, I've not been in these meetings for at least two. I'm sorry about that.

Rebecca Lyus: It's fine. I've also I've not been in the last one.

Tim Benniks: Right. So,

Rebecca Lyus: Do you feel Yeah,

Tim Benniks: we're learn together what was said.

Rebecca Lyus: we're in the same boat. I am for ease so people don't need to go back and forth to Slack. uh going to post something I posted on the 14th of July, which is a lifetime ago now. Uh in regards to uh all of the

Tim Benniks: again.

Rebecca Lyus: buckets, just so people can see who's tagged to what from where that was.

Tim Benniks: Oh, yeah. This one I've seen. Yeah, exactly. So, Patrick and Scott, are you on

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah,

Tim Benniks: these?

Patrick Bosek: Uh, I have no idea. I don't really know what's going on.

00:02:17

Patrick Bosek: I'm This is my first one.

Everett Zufelt: This is this is this is Patrick.

Rebecca Lyus: that's fine.

Tim Benniks: Ah,

Patrick Bosek: I'm Patrick.

Tim Benniks: this is your first.

Everett Zufelt: Yes.

Tim Benniks: Sorry. Sorry.

Patrick Bosek: Yeah. Nice to meet you guys.

Tim Benniks: Sorry.

Rebecca Lyus: Patrick,

Patrick Bosek: I was kind of waiting to have a Thank you.

Scott Trafford: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: Welcome to our chaos then in that case.

Scott Trafford: Yeah. I don't think I'm on

Patrick Bosek: I'm glad to be here.

Tim Benniks: There we go.

Rebecca Lyus: that's fine.

Scott Trafford: either.

Rebecca Lyus: This is a good place to start. Um,

Tim Benniks: Exactly.

Rebecca Lyus: and I'll just

Paul Sims: I'm I'm new as well to all of this. This is my first

Tim Benniks: Okay. So, we have all new people and people who've been on holiday.

Paul Sims: one.

Tim Benniks: This is perfect. I think Everett, you're the most stable person here.

Everett Zufelt: Not if not if you ask my therapist.

Tim Benniks: Uh yeah,

00:02:53

Everett Zufelt: Hey Cool.

Tim Benniks: I knew that was Nice.

Everett Zufelt: Let's give it one more minute and then we can let uh Patrick and Scott intro

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: Exactly. Yeah. Sure. Sure.

Rebecca Lyus: Um to give a little bit of context to our lovely newbies,

Tim Benniks: Yeah.

Rebecca Lyus: um what we have been previously talking about is writing some articles and the topics that I've posted into the chat were the buckets that we decided to write articles about. Um have you all had access to the GitHub repository or would you like me to copy the link in now for ease?

Paul Sims: Yes,

Tim Benniks: Yeah,

Patrick Bosek: four E

Tim Benniks: best to to paste.

Paul Sims: please.

Tim Benniks: We are all up for

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: ease.

Patrick Bosek: Please.

Rebecca Lyus: One second. I'm just getting it.

Tim Benniks: I'll paste it. I have it here.

Rebecca Lyus: Perfect.

Tim Benniks: So based on that,

Rebecca Lyus: Thank you.

Tim Benniks: we're basically just working completely in the open. Everybody who's interested can just have a look.

00:03:57

Tim Benniks: And so all our iterations, whatever we've done, it's all there. So you can see, you know, how something is born and then works into something

Rebecca Lyus: And we don't have the last meeting notes.

Tim Benniks: better.

Rebecca Lyus: Uh but we do have the one before that in all of the meetings so people can go back see what we've talked about. It's all nice open in the air.

Paul Sims: There we

Tim Benniks: So Rebecca,

Patrick Bosek: Cool.

Tim Benniks: maybe I for because we have so many new folks and I think our minute is up.

Paul Sims: go.

Rebecca Lyus: Oops.

Tim Benniks: So maybe we can just kick it off and give a bit more context of what is actually happening

Everett Zufelt: Yeah, I think that's a great

Tim Benniks: here.

Everett Zufelt: idea.

Tim Benniks: Um because we we just keep talking about buckets and you're like is this S3 or is this something else? Right.

Everett Zufelt: Yeah.

Rebecca Lyus: Stop.

Tim Benniks: That's why um Everett did you want to maybe do it

Everett Zufelt: Yeah. Do you want me to give a bit of the back?

00:04:48

Everett Zufelt: Yeah, I can give a bit of the background.

Tim Benniks: or

Everett Zufelt: So, we pulled this working group together a few months ago. It's probably been three or four months now. And the goal is really to help demonstrate for well everyone, end users and members uh in the community what patterns we are finding work well for implementing agents. And you know, we want to be really careful because there's lots of like how to build an agent things online, right? You go ask Quad Code, it'll build you an agent. So like we're we're less concerned with how to build an agent. Um we're more concerned about all of the other technical questions surrounding how to pick the right pattern, how to deal with your legacy infrastructure, what like all of the things that would actually let you build an agent and deploy it into an enterprise a pre-existing enterprise architecture. um the big I'll call it initiative that we're working on at present uh oh sorry I'll take one step back we We did publish an article uh on the mock alliance uh insights hub that just kind of gives a super highlevel overview of what we think some of the major patterns are around uh agent archetypes.

00:06:11

Everett Zufelt: And so we this word bucket keeps being thrown around. I'm trying to get people to stop saying bucket and start saying archetype.

Tim Benniks: Oh,

Everett Zufelt: Um right.

Tim Benniks: good. I didn't know.

Everett Zufelt: Yeah. and only because it's probably a more descriptive term for when should you

Tim Benniks: Thanks.

Everett Zufelt: pick this pattern.

Patrick Bosek: I plus one

Everett Zufelt: Um, yeah, we we also have a big thick uh we'll call it technical reference probably about 50page uh tech reference guide going out which which covers the same content but at a much obviously higher level of detail. It's not the sort of book that we would expect somebody to read cover to cover. Uh it's the sort of thing you'd pop in and out of as you're as you're trying to like solve problems or be like, "Hey, I'm building this type of an agent. Let me jump to the right chapter and make sure I'm hovering all the things I should be." Uh that should go out um probably in the next two or three weeks that will get published and put out the door.

00:07:11

Everett Zufelt: Uh, and like Tim said, all of this stuff is in the GitHub repo. So, you can see the the the pre-published version uh of that ebook is in the GitHub repo. And then then now I'll say the thing we're working toward over the next month or so is um uh building we'll say a hackathon in a box. And so if there's all these patterns and approaches and you know ways to choose, we want to build a hackathon Um, I think what we're calling it when we deliver it at MockX in Amsterdam at the end of September, we're calling it a build lab. But the real goal is how can we create a set of

resources that anybody could use inside a company inside like a local user group where on their own um a a a set of resources anybody could use to teach and engage and get their hands dirty with these different archetypes. So that's the big initiative that we've been working on for the last little while and that we're obviously going to work on. Hopefully not all the way to the end of September.

00:08:17

Everett Zufelt: Hopefully we finish with a little bit of breathing room before before the event. But you know, partly we're going to be doing this halfday build lab in Amsterdam, but partly it's just the a good reason to tell the world about this hackathon in a box that anybody can grab and use.

Tim Benniks: And it's it's a forcing function for us to finish it on time as well,

Everett Zufelt: Uh and burning platform.

Tim Benniks: which is nice.

Everett Zufelt: Exactly.

Tim Benniks: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: you if you give us a deadline, then we have to figure out how to how to get things done.

Tim Benniks: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: But appreciating that this is a volunteer group um and that we all have day jobs and that it's summer. Um, Scott joined in on the call today and I'll let Scott can introduce himself in a quick second. Um, but Scott joined in on the call today because he's got he he's doing some contract work around agent solution uh development for the mock alliance and he's got some cycles available if we're feeling any of our uh work is getting stuck here.

00:09:15

Everett Zufelt: Um Scott is able to help us push it along and so that's why I asked Scott to jump in today.

Tim Benniks: Oh, that's

Everett Zufelt: That's a lot of talking. Maybe we do a quick round of intros and then figure out how we want to carve out the rest of the time

Tim Benniks: awesome.

Everett Zufelt: today. Sound good?

Rebecca Lyus: Sounds

Everett Zufelt: Well, my name's Everett. Uh I talk a lot.

Rebecca Lyus: good.

Everett Zufelt: Uh my day job is I'm the VP of aentic systems at Orium and we're a system integrator uh based out of Toronto, but we cover the Americas. Uh my side of the desk job before 9 and after five is I support Rebecca and the rest of the team at the Mach Alliance uh as the program lead for the agent ecosystem initiative. Uh and so just kind of here making sure we we progress these initiatives as well as we can.

Tim Benniks: Sure.

Everett Zufelt: Maybe uh Tim and then Rebecca.

Tim Benniks: So my name is Tim Bennick and I work at content stack and I am um together with

00:10:07

Rebecca Lyus: Yep.

Tim Benniks: our colleague from versell who couldn't make it today. Um we're co-chair so effort is kind of leading us and then we are hopefully giving a little bit of structure which you have seen today did not actually happen as much but um it's really exciting to work in this stuff and so my day job is leading developer experience which also

includes um dealing with building stuff like MCP servers and CLIs that talk to agents. So it's it's very Aldriven. And so if we talk about our archetypes later, you'll see that some of our J jobs kind of are closer to certain archetypes than others. Like my stuff is more closer to one to three. And you'll see that some folks at ORM are on a little bit higher buckets or archetypes. I appreciate that you guys don't all know what these archetypes are yet, but we'll I'm sure we're going to get there. So um Rebecca

Rebecca Lyus: Hi, I'm Rebecca. So, I work for the Mac Alliance. I'm here to facilitate all your needs and as my day job, I'm working on data and systems internally.

00:11:21

Rebecca Lyus: Uh, so you'll likely see me at the Amsterdam MacX event and I hope to see you all there. And Paul, you're the first person on my top left, so I will hand over to you

Paul Sims: Okay, thank you. Um, yes, I'm Paul Sims.

Rebecca Lyus: next.

Paul Sims: I work for a consultancy um which specializes in engineering and architecture called Equal Experts. Um, we joined the Mac Alliance about a month ago. Um, I previously worked for retailers like Prim Mark, Sainsbury's, um, Marks and Spencers and a few others. These as a chief architect or CTO and I've been um working with the Mac Alliance for quite a long time but only now working for consultancy have be joined as a member. So this is all new to me at the moment. Um I've long since um stopped being an engineer. Um I'm hoping I'll still be able to keep up with most of you. My role at the moment for experts is I talk to retailers about retail technology strategy and advise them particular commerce.

00:12:21

Paul Sims: Is it something they want to engage with and what should they worry about? How do they get the data sorted? All that kind of stuff. And I'll pass to Patrick. It's top right of my

Patrick Bosek: Uh, hi everybody.

Paul Sims: screen.

Patrick Bosek: We also just joined very recently. Um, so I'm Patrick Bosek. I'm the CEO of Heredito. We're a component content management system that's uh focused on documentation content. So we don't do anything really with the content that directly surrounds e-commerce or marcom sites or pretty much anything other than documentation. Um so organizations use us to uh write product manuals, do some policy work, um deal with some like highly technical publications, but you know 80% of it it's just like product documentation. We're really excited to be here. Uh we do a lot of work with either the subsystems around agents or uh nowadays we're doing more work with like agentic workflows directly with our customers. Um, so like that's kind of picked up steam in the last, you know, call it three, four months.

00:13:24

Patrick Bosek: Um, where we're starting to do some of the work directly. Uh, I do some of it just because why not? Um, although very little of that actually goes to customers because that would be a bad idea. There's a lot of why not's there. Um, so I'm excited to uh participate here, contribute thoughts, um, get my hands dirty, those kinds of things. Uh, I guess I'll pass to uh Puneeth. Did I say your name right?

Puneeth: Yeah,

Patrick Bosek: I I did.

Puneeth: thanks Patrick. Hi, I'm Puneeth. Uh we are uh Injust Labs. We help uh brands uh build out uh in building out their own firstparty data collection infrastructure uh which works around uh ad blockers and also some sort of a cookie restrictions that Safari and other place. Um so this helps u brands to not just comply with the privacy laws also to uh ensure that there is no signal loss in terms of attribution right um because 7 days is a very short window for most brands to have conversions decent conversions so we help track uh for up to a year given on iOS device so that they can

truly understand their end to-end user journey so we recently started Ed rolling out our own MCP for uh some of the e-commerce customers uh to so that they can look at uh all the first touch, last touch, linear, multi-touch journey overlaid on top of their Google ads and meta ads to see uh what is working uh from a net new user acquisition perspective or uh where are

00:15:10

Puneeth: the users who are converting the most coming from etc. So I'm just here to understand uh what are the interesting use cases that you guys are powering and uh see what are the best practices that uh you you are already implementing out there. I think uh I think everybody has spoken right.

Scott Trafford: No, I think that leaves me. Hi,

Puneeth: Subscribe.

Scott Trafford: I'm Scott Trafford. I'm a contractor to the Mach Alliance and um started uh Trafford consulting um in this past year. uh traditionally been a ERP and EDI uh software developer. Um yeah, and I guess I'm doing a little demo today on a product that I created to help um people create items for their demos. So product catalog.

Tim Benniks: Oh, very

Scott Trafford: So product Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: Yeah.

Scott Trafford: So, some product catalog uh generators.

Tim Benniks: meta.

Scott Trafford: We in doing some of these uh agents, we ran into some problems with finding item pictures, you know, that aren't stolen from somewhere or terrible or some, you know, random dude looking in a mirror when you want a mirror picture, you know, that kind of thing.

00:16:38

Scott Trafford: So, uh I created a uh catalog generator. So whenever we're ready, I can demo

Everett Zufelt: That would be great.

Scott Trafford: that.

Everett Zufelt: So, so for Tim, I think the I think Hey, today I think there's maybe two things I'd like I'd like to see us do. Um, and then open to anybody else's thoughts in the group. The first one is I'd love to to have Scott do the demo. I think for anybody who's had to demo anything that includes a product catalog, I think we all know how much of a pain it is to actually source a catalog.

Tim Benniks: Yeah,

Everett Zufelt: Uh,

Tim Benniks: sure.

Everett Zufelt: and then so you either have a really bad catalog or you have a catalog that is you probably don't own the right to use, but you use it anyway because you needed one. And so, uh, and hey, that happens. And so I think Scott's got a really good solution he's put together here, and I know we've used at ORUM. um for some of our um demos.

00:17:37

Everett Zufelt: And then the second thing I'd like to do is just do a real quick rundown on where we are and what's left to get done between now and mock x. Uh and make sure we have names assigned to everything. And if there's things that need to be done with no names, uh, then we can have Scott pick those up because he's got some time available. Um,

Tim Benniks: I wonder Everett should we maybe start with the last part because that's quite well if we do that then

Everett Zufelt: you want to start with that? Sure.

Tim Benniks: we have a lot of time for Scott because I'm sure we're going to have questions and it's super fun because I have that pain

Everett Zufelt: Perfect.

Tim Benniks: Scott so maybe you can solve my pain also.

Scott Trafford: I hope

Everett Zufelt: And we're and we're open sourcing this as part of MACH Alliance as well.

Scott Trafford: so.

Tim Benniks: Oh, that's

Everett Zufelt: So like so it's gonna be everybody can use it,

Tim Benniks: cool.

Everett Zufelt: right? It's so um so let's start with the second one then.

00:18:21

Everett Zufelt: I like that idea,

Tim Benniks: Yeah,

Scott Trafford: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: Tim.

Tim Benniks: let's do the boring stuff first and

Everett Zufelt: Okay. So I think I mean broadly speaking I want to put because

Tim Benniks: then

Everett Zufelt: I like the rule of threes. Uh I want to put the hackathon into three buckets. Bucket one is just logistics and admin. And maybe uh Rebecca even even though I think you're pretty fresh back from holiday, you might be able to give us some form of update there. Bucket two is we'll call it like the the the the

Tim Benniks: She matters.

Everett Zufelt: content that needs to wrap around all of the prototypes. So maybe more like the here here are the options, here's the scenarios, how can we help you?

And then the third part being we were working on four or maybe five packaged prototypes so that people have like a reference they can look at and poke at rather than starting from scratch. Um so maybe we'll start with Rebecca. Is there anything you can share with us around logistics?

00:19:18

Everett Zufelt: I know we've started advertising this. I've seen it in my

Rebecca Lyus: Yes. Uh,

Everett Zufelt: email.

Rebecca Lyus: unfortunately I am a little too fresh back and I'm getting all my updates tomorrow when someone else is back. Everyone will wait for August is

Everett Zufelt: Perfect.

Tim Benniks: But the fact that it's marketed means we are pretty far in,

Everett Zufelt: We're We're a go. We're Yes. So, we've started to market it.

Rebecca Lyus: We are.

Tim Benniks: right?

Everett Zufelt: We've carved out the date and time. Um maybe Rebecca if you'd be able to then just drop the notes into the Slack

Rebecca Lyus: Yes.

Everett Zufelt: channel um once you get the update later this week that would be that would be really helpful.

Rebecca Lyus: Yes.

Everett Zufelt: My understanding is things are moving smoothly on the logistics

Tim Benniks: Yes. So I imagine things like fan room materials,

Rebecca Lyus: Logistic

Tim Benniks: all that stuff should be just fine, right?

Rebecca Lyus: materials. I know we haven't sorted yet. Uh the new room I know we have sorted.

00:20:06

Tim Benniks: Okay.

Rebecca Lyus: I believe we're in the yellow room. Um which holds probably no context.

Tim Benniks: No,

Rebecca Lyus: Um you'll be able to find it easy enough.

Tim Benniks: that's fine.

Rebecca Lyus: It's the only yellow room.

Tim Benniks: Yeah,

Rebecca Lyus: Um and it is in the agenda

Tim Benniks: exactly.

Rebecca Lyus: now. So from 1 to 1:30 is the foundations which is when people are going to be talking explaining and then 1:30 till 4:30 is when people are going to be building.

Tim Benniks: And one quick thing because I'm also quite fresh back. What is the exact date? Was it the 29th?

Rebecca Lyus: This is please hold

Tim Benniks: Because I do remember the date was good for me because the next day I have to do the same thing but at the conference for content stack. And so it it kind of needs to be balanced because if these dates change,

Rebecca Lyus: I'm

Tim Benniks: it's going to be hard.

Rebecca Lyus: I am just loading up the agenda. We can build

Patrick Bosek: While you're doing that, can I ask even more basic question?

00:21:10

Patrick Bosek: I heard the word Slack channel,

Rebecca Lyus: that.

Patrick Bosek: but I don't know how I'm not in Slack.

Tim Benniks: Oh, Patrick,

Patrick Bosek: How do I get that?

Tim Benniks: you're going to invite you.

Patrick Bosek: Okay,

Tim Benniks: I think Rebecca, can you do that?

Patrick Bosek: cool.

Tim Benniks: Is that an is there an easy way?

Rebecca Lyus: I can indeed. Uh, and yes,

Tim Benniks: Awesome.

Patrick Bosek: Thank you.

Rebecca Lyus: it is on the 29th.

Tim Benniks: It's 29th. Okay,

Rebecca Lyus: Um, I did just because I was on a different screen. Can I just confirm who asked me to add them to a Slack

Tim Benniks: cool.

Rebecca Lyus: channel?

Patrick Bosek: Uh, yeah, that's Patrick Bosek.

Rebecca Lyus: Perfect. I will add

Patrick Bosek: Awesome.

Paul Sims: And probably me as

Rebecca Lyus: you.

Patrick Bosek: I don't know that I'm even in the Slack workspace yet. So,

Rebecca Lyus: Oh,

Paul Sims: well.

Rebecca Lyus: we can invite you.

Tim Benniks: Yeah,

Rebecca Lyus: That's fine.

Tim Benniks: you you there's like a Mac Alliance member Slack workspace.

00:21:43

Patrick Bosek: excellent.

Tim Benniks: So, if you guys are members,

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Patrick Bosek: We are. Yeah.

Tim Benniks: most likely you should either be invited soon or it already has happened.

Patrick Bosek: Yeah. I could have missed it. It's possible. I'll check my email, but uh if you want to reinvite me, that would be super helpful.

Rebecca Lyus: I will just do that

Tim Benniks: So maybe to take a tiny step back because we're looking at these this this

Rebecca Lyus: now.

Tim Benniks: this workshop we're coming up of. What whatever what did you call it ever? It wasn't a workshop but build lab.

Rebecca Lyus: Build love.

Tim Benniks: Ah that sounds good. That's the way. And so we have these archetypes from very simple some sort of miniature LLM assisted workflows in automations to like full agents doing crazy things together with a full autonomy. Right? So there there's a very wide spectrum here. And so the idea is that in this build lab people look at their own business and say hey where are we and what kind of do we need?

00:22:39

Tim Benniks: Are we like archetype number three that is kind of goal oriented but it's still a little bit like human pushed? Are we there or are we super far in and we can just let our agents do their thing and then it's up to us in the room to kind of teach people this is what we think is probably a good archetype for you. So just try and build it and go home with something that you think actually might work. So, for the folks that didn't know exactly what it meant when we said like this lab thing, that's that's kind of the idea that we're going for. I haven't been in Sorry.

Rebecca Lyus: So I do I was just going to raise one thing uh just some based

Tim Benniks: Go on, Rebecca.

Rebecca Lyus: on a previous conversation with her with Holly we are making a note that people are not likely to be able to complete a full agent in this time but they'll be able to go away and finish it because trying to build an agent in 3 hours wasn't necessarily Feasible was the

00:23:39

Tim Benniks: Ah, okay. Well,

Rebecca Lyus: concern.

Tim Benniks: it I don't even know. Like, we will have to check because sometimes if the use case is very simple, it might be a 10-minute job, but people just didn't know yet,

Everett Zufelt: I feel it feels like we might be getting pretty pedantic on that point.

Tim Benniks: right?

Rebecca Lyus: Okay.

Tim Benniks: Yeah, maybe we just don't worry about it

Everett Zufelt: Good rule of good rule of thumb, people show up in the afternoon, have fun,

Tim Benniks: now.

Everett Zufelt: learn things. If you finish an agent, great. If you go away with learning and you maybe didn't finish your agent, that's okay, too.

Tim Benniks: Yeah. So the the only thing on that Rebecca that I have is like because I don't know what the decisions were when I was out. What are the tools we use to enable people to build these agents? Because if those tools stop working when you go home, that's less good, of course.

Rebecca Lyus: that I think we haven't actually decided on yet.

00:24:25

Everett Zufelt: And I think that's and I think that is part of the logistics aspect.

Tim Benniks: All right.

Rebecca Lyus: What

Everett Zufelt: It sounds like Tim,

Tim Benniks: Exactly.

Everett Zufelt: you've got some thoughts on that. Would you mind owning that action with Rebecca?

Tim Benniks: Of course.

Everett Zufelt: Then be grace.

Tim Benniks: Yeah. We just have to and I won't go too deep on it now because it might bore people, but we have to figure out do we ask sponsors to provide like an agent workspace or something and from their SAS, but then do these have to be members? Does that look like favoritism? do like that's it's a really hard decision for us to make on how that might

Rebecca Lyus: That was

Tim Benniks: work.

Patrick Bosek: What are what do we expect the level of sophistication for people who are starting these agents?

Rebecca Lyus: that.

Patrick Bosek: to be like are they

Everett Zufelt: It's it's it's a good Yeah.

Rebecca Lyus: Next.

Tim Benniks: It's going to be a mix.

Everett Zufelt: And it's a good question because I think the goal is we want to be

00:25:08

Tim Benniks: It

Patrick Bosek: like

Tim Benniks: is

Everett Zufelt: indifferent. So, uh, the whole the whole premise of having like those archetypes that are like super simple,

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: probably not even an agent on the one hand, like, hey, look, you can use an LLM to generate content uh,

Rebecca Lyus: Okay.

Everett Zufelt: as part of a workflow through to on the other hand, here's multiple agents like negotiating across organizational boundaries. Like I think the goal of having the them is so that we can people can kind of put up their hand for the one that they feel most comfortable playing around

Tim Benniks: Yeah.

Patrick Bosek: One of the

Tim Benniks: And also then inspire them around it, right?

Patrick Bosek: things,

Tim Benniks: Maybe they can move move an archetype up if they feel like, hey, this fits me. Sorry. Go on, Patrick.

Patrick Bosek: one of the things that's been really successful here at Hereda is that we have this uh there's one of the open source courses. It's it's pretty easy to follow. Um, and before I'll sit down with anybody in the company and work with them on trying to

establish an agent to do X, Y, or Z, I basically say, "You have to go through this." And it takes,

00:26:14

Patrick Bosek: I don't know, 30 minutes, an hour. Like, it's it's not a lot of effort, but it it forms they, you know, they build an agent operating system. It's like it's it's super basic stuff, but they they come out of it understanding kind of what an agent like one archetype of an agent is. And I find that the conversation with that individual after having gone through that is far more productive than it is if you just go in and you're like, "Okay, the most basic agent is a text file." And they're like, "How is that possible?" Um,

Tim Benniks: Yeah. Yeah,

Patrick Bosek: so would it be would we be open to saying like the price of admission is having gone through

Tim Benniks: sure.

Patrick Bosek: this like one hour of prep time and like that would bring the level the floor floor up and allow us to have more sophisticated conversations. Just an idea

Tim Benniks: The thing is as Oh,

Everett Zufelt: I I like I like the ide sorry I like the idea of a like suggest I I

00:27:01

Tim Benniks: sorry. Whatever.

Patrick Bosek: like

Everett Zufelt: think the price of admission is hard because people don't do homework but I

Tim Benniks: Yeah. Nobody will do it, but we like it.

Everett Zufelt: liked but I like the idea of saying hey we recommend you do

Tim Benniks: You know what I mean?

Everett Zufelt: So,

Tim Benniks: True.

Everett Zufelt: like I think I think we should definitely include it in like as people put up their hand and and say I want to join in on this and sign up.

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: I think we should definitely say you'll get the most out of your time if I just wouldn't make it a hard

Rebecca Lyus: No,

Patrick Bosek: The other thing you could do is we could we could separate the group,

Rebecca Lyus: agree.

Patrick Bosek: right? So you could have if you do this, you go into this group. If you don't, you basically do go into a group that does that, right? Um, so that's one way that you can kind of make it more of like a soft price of admission.

00:27:48

Tim Benniks: But we we don't have multiple spaces. But I do like that, Patrick, because I've been thinking there might be like more a lot of folks that have the mandate of use all this stuff, but they don't really know yet. And this is the perfect place with their peers to kind of learn about the different approaches. So there might be one group that really does need that basic like the text file can actually get you there already, right? That is really interesting. But I'm sure I already know a few people that want to attend and they are so advanced they're just going to be bored in one minute if we don't give them the hardest problem. So yeah, I don't know yet. Like but this question was asked before and this is like two meetings ago.

Patrick Bosek: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: So Rebecca, do we have deadlines where we really need to say, "Okay, now this is it." And we move forward.

Rebecca Lyus: We don't have hard

Tim Benniks: No,

Rebecca Lyus: deadlines.

Tim Benniks: it's just the more the later we are, the more it burns.

00:28:48

Tim Benniks: Maybe that's

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: easiest.

Rebecca Lyus: Um I'm happy for us to set deadlines and we manage ourselves.

Tim Benniks: Yeah, it tends to work generally. So, um, Everett, in terms of that first bucket we were talking about now, the whom who does what stuff, like I'm happy to, uh, work with Rebecca on like the tooling that we might use.

Everett Zufelt: I Yep.

Tim Benniks: What else do we

Everett Zufelt: I uh Well,

Tim Benniks: need?

Everett Zufelt: why don't we do this as the takeaway? Would you and Rebecca be willing to come back to our next session with the list and where we're at?

Tim Benniks: Yeah,

Everett Zufelt: I think it's I think it's tooling,

Tim Benniks: that works.

Everett Zufelt: comms, and like room setup and logistics,

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: right? like the hey if do we have a place do people have the right prerequisites and do they

Tim Benniks: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: know where they're supposed to be and when they're supposed to be there and love the idea of of sharing that that online course out in advance with people as they sign up.

00:29:44

Tim Benniks: Yeah. So

Everett Zufelt: So I think I think if the two of you want to come back to us maybe even if you maybe could maybe come back

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: like sometime in the next week just in the Slack channel with an update.

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: I think. That would be really

Tim Benniks: Yeah, Rebecca, if we take it offline,

Everett Zufelt: helpful.

Tim Benniks: I we can just send you a DM with a whole list of stuff because I've done a few of those, right? And so we can just see what works and what doesn't and then maybe we just decide and then it's not like in a a big group meeting where things keep changing.

Everett Zufelt: Love that idea. Tell us what you're doing. We can tell you we don't like it,

Tim Benniks: Yes, this is the

Everett Zufelt: but tell us what you plan to do and we can disagree quietly

Tim Benniks: way.

Everett Zufelt: or loudly, but at least Yes.

Tim Benniks: Well, yeah, that's the thing. You might get all one veto or something.

00:30:26

Tim Benniks: No, we'll figure it out. It's all good. No, but that way we we have a little bit more action. I think that's nice. And the thing is, if we have something that we kind of like,

Rebecca Lyus: Mhm.

Tim Benniks: it's much easier to break those rules than if there are no rules, you know?

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: Okay. Well, let's take that offline. That makes things easier. Um,

Everett Zufelt: for the for the second I want to jump to the third part um for the building of

Tim Benniks: Everett. Oh,

Everett Zufelt: the prototypes so that people have something something to poke at and kick around and say

Tim Benniks: yeah. That was my next question. So, it fits.

Everett Zufelt: hey I could have done it better and well you could have done it better then go do it right that's why we're all here do it Um the the archetype five which is the kind of crossorg boundaries one I'm d done dusted. It works.

00:31:15

Everett Zufelt: Now I'm just going through and like cleaning up crap that claude stuck in there because spoiler alert I didn't I didn't write the

Tim Benniks: Oh,

Everett Zufelt: code. Um but it works.

Tim Benniks: nice.

Everett Zufelt: It it's it's a buyer agent. It negotiates across three different sellers agents. uh finds the best price for the inventory it's looking to purchase and then makes the purchase using stable coin through Stripes. And so all done, dusted, it

works. It's wonderful. I'm just cleaning it up so that it's less embarrassing because, you know, having having been an engine a software engineer in a former life, I I like things nice and clean,

Tim Benniks: I will judge you so hard,

Everett Zufelt: but I appreciate I know that's my that is my uh impostor

Tim Benniks: Everett. You know this.

Everett Zufelt: syndrome coming out. Uh, so it's it's basically done and dusted. Uh, I'm I'm hope hopefully I'm going to get it up and pushed today or tomorrow. Uh, I just want to like there there were some chunks in there worth and refactoring and like I'm not being too precious about it because it's a prototype and also some of the tools I'm working with here like just barely exist, right?

00:32:20

Everett Zufelt: Like this is new stuff. It's like A2A as like the communication protocol. It's, you know, it's been around for a little while, but like the the libraries are new, so like some of these things are so new they they kind of barely work together. Anyway, so I'll push it up there and we can poke around at it. Um, I know Danielle had sent a note in the Slack yesterday or earlier today that yep,

Tim Benniks: Yeah. For his bucket four, right?

Everett Zufelt: that that one is underway.

Tim Benniks: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: I no worries about that one getting done. So it's archetype one which is really just very simple showing where an LLM um is uh used as part of a deterministic workflow to generate things, not even really being agentic.

Tim Benniks: Yeah,

Everett Zufelt: Number two,

Tim Benniks: my plan for that one was just because it well that's my name.

Everett Zufelt: oh, you're working on that one. Okay.

Tim Benniks: I just now saw that's my name there.

Everett Zufelt: Okay.

Tim Benniks: So I'm planning to just do the simplest thing.

00:33:12

Everett Zufelt: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: It's like some sort of automation like an a an N8 thing where it just translate the page or

Everett Zufelt: Well,

Tim Benniks: something like from French to English or something like that more than

Everett Zufelt: I I I think I think that's seems very perfectly reasonable to me.

Tim Benniks: enough. I don't see a name for two but that might be me also because it's so close to

Everett Zufelt: Yeah.

Patrick Bosek: I have a I have an agent that I've built recently.

Tim Benniks: one.

Patrick Bosek: It's I mean it's kind of like more of a harness and I guess we should Everybody defines agents differently. So at some point I'd love to hear how they're defined in this group so I

Tim Benniks: Yep.

Everett Zufelt: We we spent we spent our first two working group sessions trying to answer that question.

Patrick Bosek: can Okay,

Everett Zufelt: We we ca we came up we came up with four and a half answers.

Patrick Bosek: maybe there's like notes I can go look at. Okay.

Tim Benniks: But now we have the word harness.

00:33:54

Patrick Bosek: All right.

Tim Benniks: Can we please start

Everett Zufelt: So

Patrick Bosek: Okay, great.

Tim Benniks: again?

Patrick Bosek: Um, so I have one that I built for specifically for release notes. Um,

Tim Benniks: Oh,

Patrick Bosek: it's uh I could we could use that if we want to.

Tim Benniks: nice.

Patrick Bosek: It's open source. Uh, we have a a site that's soft launch called Heredo Open Projects uh which is designed to just release AI related agents and harness type things.

Tim Benniks: I'm I'm feeling like something like you just made. We we would consider that an agent, not another not a harness per se, but it's kind of similar. I would say it's hard to

Patrick Bosek: I mean, it's technically an app. Like,

Tim Benniks: judge.

Patrick Bosek: it's like it's it's actually a piece of software that you then configure AI into to run a workflow. So,

Tim Benniks: Yeah. Okay.

Patrick Bosek: I'm happy to use whatever whatever nomenclature that we use in this group. Like, I'm happy to just go along with that.

00:34:45

Patrick Bosek: So, I'm I'm just trying to feel out like how you guys call

Everett Zufelt: Yeah,

Tim Benniks: So may this is a good question effort.

Everett Zufelt: we haven't we haven't had we haven't had the harness debate yet. Um so,

Tim Benniks: No.

Everett Zufelt: uh let we should probably add it to our list of things to talk about as a group. Um,

Tim Benniks: Yes.

Everett Zufelt: but regardless whether we call the thing you did an agent or a harness, um, I think it could be still a valuable thing for us to to use as one of the

Tim Benniks: Ever, I have a quick question on that because you already coded some stuff.

Everett Zufelt: prototypes.

Tim Benniks: Did we discuss in what languages, what tools, what built systems, whatever, what do what do we use for these or it really just doesn't

Everett Zufelt: Well, I think I think our goal was I mean I'm of two minds.

Tim Benniks: matter?

Everett Zufelt: A maybe three. A, we never discussed. B, I think whoever's building, like if what we're trying to show is many different ways of solving problems, I'm not too fussy about picking one.

00:35:43

Tim Benniks: Okay.

Everett Zufelt: Like I think everybody should, you know,

Tim Benniks: But don't use closed stuff that only you have access to through your job,

Everett Zufelt: do I think that I think that's probably a good principle,

Tim Benniks: for example.

Everett Zufelt: right? If we want to show them to people and have people use them.

Tim Benniks: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: But number three. also is, and this might be a little bit heretical of a point of view, um I firmly believe we're getting close. We're not there yet, but we're getting close to why should I even care?

Tim Benniks: I agree.

Everett Zufelt: Like, like if you know,

Tim Benniks: Yes.

Everett Zufelt: if I write the spec and claude or co-pilot writes the code, why do I care what library I chose to use,

Tim Benniks: As long as it's open and everybody can use it,

Everett Zufelt: right? Interop, right?

Tim Benniks: I'm happy to do whatever you want.

Everett Zufelt: So like interop standards like how does this thing talk to that thing I care but whether that was written in Python or Java or whatever I probably don't care very much any anymore you know so I think yeah I think it just go with what go with what you know so

00:36:41

Tim Benniks: Okay, easy. So, Patrick, go and build whatever it

Everett Zufelt: so sorry two so so two of the five are well underway it's one two

Tim Benniks: is.

Everett Zufelt: and three that need an owner. It sounds like Tim,

Tim Benniks: I'll take one and two.

Everett Zufelt: you were maybe taking one and two and that leaves three up for

Tim Benniks: Well,

Everett Zufelt: grabs.

Tim Benniks: there's names there. We have Doug and Ryan.

Everett Zufelt: So maybe Rebecca, would you mind following up with Doug and Ryan?

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: I don't think they're on today to see if they need help.

Rebecca Lyus: Yes. No

Everett Zufelt: And then Tim, do you need help on one and

Tim Benniks: I don't know yet.

Everett Zufelt: two?

Rebecca Lyus: problem.

Tim Benniks: I'm going to wake up after my holiday and actually look at those.

Everett Zufelt: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: But I'm thinking it's fine because in my daytoday these come up quite a lot with

Everett Zufelt: Okay. If you do need help,

Tim Benniks: my customers.

Everett Zufelt: let us know because again,

00:37:24

Tim Benniks: Yes.

Everett Zufelt: Scott does have some cycles that he could help push it along.

Tim Benniks: Oh, that's cool. Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: But I mean, he's working he is working on other stuff.

Tim Benniks: Cool.

Everett Zufelt: So, let us know if if you need help moving it along, let us know. Otherwise, we'll keep trucking with it.

Tim Benniks: Um,

Everett Zufelt: Cool.

Tim Benniks: should we take 20 minutes for Scott's demo or do we have something else to

Everett Zufelt: I think that was all I had. Anybody else have something?

Tim Benniks: discuss?

Everett Zufelt: I we'll Rebecca, you'll make sure everybody's in the Slack channel. And then Scott, I'm I'm We've talked about this, but I don't think I had the

Scott Trafford: Okay,

Everett Zufelt: demo.

Scott Trafford: Patrick,

Patrick Bosek: So just quick question.

Scott Trafford: did you have

Patrick Bosek: Yeah, I was just wondering, do you want me to contribute to any of these archetypes buckets?

Scott Trafford: something?

Everett Zufelt: Absolut.

Patrick Bosek: Um,

Tim Benniks: Dude,

Everett Zufelt: Yeah,

Tim Benniks: yes.

Everett Zufelt: absolutely.

Tim Benniks: Go.

00:38:04

Tim Benniks: If you have another version of five,

Patrick Bosek: sure.

Everett Zufelt: Um

Tim Benniks: just do it and then we can see where we are, right? Why

Patrick Bosek: I I'm not sure I totally understand the difference between them.

Tim Benniks: not?

Patrick Bosek: So, maybe if somebody wants to take 30 minutes of me after like offline to talk to me about like how how it's

Everett Zufelt: Absolutely.

Patrick Bosek: divided, um, I think that would be really helpful.

Everett Zufelt: Once you're uh once you're in the Slack channel,

Patrick Bosek: Yep.

Everett Zufelt: ping me and then we can find some time.

Patrick Bosek: Okay. Okay,

Everett Zufelt: Yeah. Every We want more.

Patrick Bosek: cool.

Everett Zufelt: The more the marrier.

Tim Benniks: Yeah, exactly. We just because this is the thing.

Patrick Bosek: Okay,

Tim Benniks: The more we diverge into different places, we don't know where this stuff lands. Next week might be different again,

Patrick Bosek: there.

Tim Benniks: right?

Scott Trafford: Okay. Um, let's see here. Okay, so the problem we had was we kept getting either very poor images or stolen images or random things like a cat statue in New York City instead of a vanity or something, right?

00:39:12

Scott Trafford: So anyway, to solve this problem, I just made a generator. So, it's organized into catalogues or sites, if you will, and each site has a very simple list of categories. So, for clothing, you have jackets and tops and pants and all that kind of stuff. And you can just add um categories very simply, you know, if you came up with some new thing, you could add it here. You could add hats or whatever. And then when you're When you need to generate or create images, um you can do it one at a time or

you can do a batch ad. So you can tell it to say uh create uh five uh women's we don't have a lot of women's clothes here yet. Women's uh skirts of various lengths. and say smart casual casual casual. Give it like a style. Uh you can give it a price range although to be honest um it's not the best at distributing equally. And then what it does is it generates uh in this case five items.

00:40:45

Scott Trafford: Um you can look over all the different tags and colors and descriptions. Um and it generates for you what is going to be sent down to the image generation uh LLM. So you can review those, you can change them, and then when you're happy, you just click the generate images. It makes the call out to um chat GPT image one and you wait, you know, a minute or whatever.

Everett Zufelt: Is there is there a reason you chose image one and not image two? Just out of curiosity,

Tim Benniks: I guess price.

Everett Zufelt: the price.

Scott Trafford: just yeah it's it this is uh not super fast

Everett Zufelt: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: Yeah,

Everett Zufelt: Yeah, I'm with you.

Tim Benniks: price.

Scott Trafford: but for our purposes it's good enough. I these aren't going to go into production anywhere I don't imagine. Maybe they will.

Everett Zufelt: They're to give the feel of like a cat.

Scott Trafford: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: Yes.

Scott Trafford: And so it's it's one of those things where it's good enough. Um, and so when you're happy with everything, you add them to the catalog.

00:41:53

Scott Trafford: And then if you if there's maybe one you don't love, um, you can go back in and say, "Okay, I didn't love I don't know, I didn't love this one." And so there's a tweak at the bottom. And so you can say, uh, add some accent color. And what it does in this case is it takes the existing image and the tweak and the tweak

Everett Zufelt: I like that.

Scott Trafford: sends them both down so you don't start fresh with something it you know and just get some completely different thing.

Everett Zufelt: I like that because I that that like the call costs a little bit more,

Scott Trafford: Um,

Everett Zufelt: but you're more likely to get What actually wanted back?

Scott Trafford: right. And so if you were like, let's say you wanted to, you have a particular style,

Everett Zufelt: Yeah.

Scott Trafford: you're trying to make a whole bunch of things out and they don't fit, you can tweak them so that your demo looks a little better. Um,

Tim Benniks: Scott, quick question.

Scott Trafford: which is we which Yeah.

00:42:54

Tim Benniks: Do you have general rules? Because I put that in the chat here because you see it quite often. Let's say you're and you're you're pitching to a luxury customer, right?

Scott Trafford: Yes.

Tim Benniks: you're a luxury brand and you have something that's just like a percent off, your meeting will be about that image,

Scott Trafford: Yep.

Tim Benniks: right? So,

Scott Trafford: Yep.

Tim Benniks: if you can send some sort of brand guidelines, do you have that?

Scott Trafford: So what it what it has here is you have a base call the base prompt.

Tim Benniks: Uh,

Scott Trafford: Okay. So for each site you have the base prompt.

Tim Benniks: okay.

Scott Trafford: So here we're creating an image for a clothing shopping website PDP page uh for the following product. It must have white background, no text, you know, da da da.

Everett Zufelt: I like that.

Scott Trafford: So if that fits in here, you can put that here and save it.

Everett Zufelt: Yeah.

Scott Trafford: And then you just put item in squiggies and then the item squiggies is replaced with um this query here that it comes up with.

00:43:53

Tim Benniks: Oh,

Scott Trafford: And then you can keep re you can keep regenerating the description if you want to change the tags and the name

Tim Benniks: that's awesome.

Scott Trafford: and the color and all that jazz. You can you can change this and then it'll generate a new description and then based on the new description you can generate a new uh query.

Tim Benniks: That's awesome.

Scott Trafford: So here it didn't really come up with adding some color.

Tim Benniks: Thanks,

Scott Trafford: It changed the color. So I'm like, so I go back and I would Okay. Um, I'd have to tweak my tweak query. So for here, I just keep original and it keeps the original image and you can move on. So you can generate a whole bunch um, you know, 20 or 30 at once and just kind of walk away. It batches it in uh, I don't know, three or four or five depending on and then when you you can make a little snapshot. If you're going to make a big change, you can just make a snapshot of all the images in case, you know, everything gets screwed up.

00:44:54

Scott Trafford: And then when you're ready to export, you can um create a new export. I've got a couple that we built. Um but you can just paste a new schema and then the LLM will try and match your fields from two and then you can you can tweak it too. So if I go here and just say I'm gonna say here L And I'm going to It's going to take a stab at it. Oh, I got to give it a name. So now it's trying to match what what it has versus where it's going. And since Algolia doesn't actually have anything other than object ID, it just gives you everything you have already. You can deselect anything you want to deselect. Uh you can choose any or all categories, whatever you want to do. Uh and it'll download and give you a zip file. You can give it a file path for your new destination so you don't have to move everything into files, right? And you can do stuff like um you know images and then you can say uh object ID in brackets and it will put the object ID as part of your path.

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Scott Trafford: Um and then down here you have a preview of what you're going to end up with just from like the first found record. Shows you what you're going to end up with. So this is a largely untested work in progress to export. So if you have any ideas, let me know. Um but anyway, you end up with uh a zip file that you can pull into

your site that you're working on or you can connect directly. Like here I'm actually connected to one of the demos I'm working on um locally. So yeah.

Tim Benniks: I'm wondering because the one thing I would love for this to have is not give me a zip file but actually just have an endpoint.

Scott Trafford: Yeah. So you can you're I'm already doing that. So you can just live well I'm um working right

Tim Benniks: You just make your own SAS now basically.

Scott Trafford: now on a on a catalog path um so on the same unit. So, we could easily add that um in here cuz

00:47:39

Tim Benniks: Yeah, because you can imagine.

Scott Trafford: I'm actually I'm actually work working on um a different

Tim Benniks: Sorry. Go on.

Scott Trafford: project on the same server. Um, and so I'm actually modifying these uh like on the live bases.

Tim Benniks: Yeah,

Scott Trafford: So they're actually the images that are being

Tim Benniks: because I'm wondering if this is done for clouinary because they're a member

Scott Trafford: used.

Tim Benniks: here at Mac Alliance. You just ask them, can I just use your CDN to put all these images on? And then suddenly you can make a whole bunch of these different catalogs that people can then just choose

Scott Trafford: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: from and it just comes from clouinary from a free account that you get from them.

Scott Trafford: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: And then suddenly you made a whole surface and I would use that in every demo if I can just choose like earrings and apparently there was a bunch of earrings type things already. I'll just go with that catalog and just implement it in my project.

Scott Trafford: Yeah.

00:48:32

Scott Trafford: And so that's what this is doing here. This is actually just off this other solution that I'm working on. I'm just modifying them live.

Tim Benniks: Nice.

Scott Trafford: So I can test that with the URL, that kind of stuff.

Tim Benniks: Yeah.

Scott Trafford: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: Nice. And

Everett Zufelt: And it's just been like what is like a pain in digital for anybody

Tim Benniks: maybe

Everett Zufelt: who's ever had to be a sales engineer in this space on whether on the consultant or the tech side. This has been like the pain in the ass for like literally ever literally ever.

Scott Trafford: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: Uh

Scott Trafford: And we were I was tried iteration after iteration of trying to get it to go find better images and I was literally ending up with we were working on the home site. So like uh vanities and stuff and we were I was literally getting pictures of cat statues in what looked like New York City sidewalk and I was like it was just so frustrating.

Tim Benniks: Yeah, better just generate then, right?

00:49:36

Scott Trafford: Yeah. Yeah.

Tim Benniks: Well, it but I cannot imagine it's very cheap

Everett Zufelt: And and it's good and it's good enough like 12 12 you know what they're not I mean

Scott Trafford: And

Tim Benniks: though.

Everett Zufelt: image gen I was playing around on the weekend with image gen 2 and it's like I don't know call it for lack of a sake of argument you know 25 cents an image you know, 15 to 20. So, if you want a thousand, like let's say you wanted a thousand images, it's like call it \$250 if you do it once,

Scott Trafford: I think I did all of these images and all of the testing and the back

Everett Zufelt: right?

Scott Trafford: and forth for probably under \$25.

Tim Benniks: Oh, that's not bad.

Everett Zufelt: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: Maybe the price has changed because I just put a a web

Scott Trafford: Um, so yeah,

Everett Zufelt: It's not It's not like expensive like it's expensive if you were doing a thousand a day, right?

Scott Trafford: I mean we can there's I did look into putting the cost like as a sum,

00:50:28

Tim Benniks: Yeah. Nice.

Scott Trafford: but they don't all give the actual cost because what you're doing is you're working on credits, right? And the credits don't necessarily translate directly to per dollar.

Tim Benniks: No.

Scott Trafford: Um it would be more of a guess, but you can you could add we could add that um with a you know disclaimer star star that it accurate within you know certain amount

Everett Zufelt: Yeah, whatever.

Scott Trafford: be.

Everett Zufelt: There's another provider. I ran across again on the weekend uh I'd never heard telev before f.AI AI, forget what it stands for, features and something. Um, it's it's a it's like an a model aggregator router very similar to like an open router or a Versel AIS or AI gateway. Um, but it's all for video. All they route is uh audio, image, and video models. And so not not just Yeah. like audio video and image models which I thought was like an interesting collection of

Tim Benniks: Yeah, it's like 11 labs does that now too.

Everett Zufelt: models.

00:51:35

Tim Benniks: You can just Oh,

Everett Zufelt: Uh but the yeah the these guys have 11 labs in their router but they also have right so

Tim Benniks: also Oh, that's fun.

Everett Zufelt: they have 11 labs and they also have like open AAI's image to they they've got basically it's just a collection of video audio and image models all through one endpoint. Um, again, very similar to Open Router, but Open Router doesn't have things like 11 Labs in it. So, um, this one I found it interesting to be able to play around with.

Scott Trafford: What was it

Everett Zufelt: F.AI.

Scott Trafford: called?

Everett Zufelt: I'd never heard Telot before. Thanks, Patrick. Yeah, I'd never heard Tel before, but I just ran across it on I was basically looking for one provider that could give me image gen 2 and 11 Labs with one API key,

Tim Benniks: Yeah,

Everett Zufelt: and these guys were the one that came up.

Tim Benniks: that's nice. Isn't it Is it expensive?

Everett Zufelt: It's basically just pass through pricing. I'm sure they add a little bit on top,

00:52:32

Tim Benniks: Oh, okay. Okay.

Everett Zufelt: but it's it wasn't that expensive. But now I can generate like speech, sound effects, images, all on one endpoint.

Scott Trafford: Yeah,

Everett Zufelt: So yeah for for

Scott Trafford: I found that the GPT1 was sufficient for this.

Tim Benniks: Nice.

Everett Zufelt: images it's I mean it's

Scott Trafford: Yeah. So, yeah, I mean, they're they're not perfect,

Everett Zufelt: yeah and

Scott Trafford: but I mean, we got what we needed. Um,

Everett Zufelt: if you use if you use image

Scott Trafford: it's generating what looks like like those look like actual

Everett Zufelt: to

Tim Benniks: This is as small as they are,

Scott Trafford: things.

Tim Benniks: they look very good from here.

Scott Trafford: Well, they're not that small, but yeah.

Tim Benniks: Oh, this looks great.

Scott Trafford: So, yeah. I mean that you can't complain about

Tim Benniks: I wish I had this stuff, man, because I put a link in the chat. I worked on that website like a year ago,

Scott Trafford: that.

Tim Benniks: maybe. It has a lot of product images, and I used GPT, like the image one as well, but back then it was still expensive.

00:53:27

Tim Benniks: I think it took me a few weeks to get it there, but it's also like big hero shots of moving models and videos and stuff. It's pretty intense.

Scott Trafford: Yeah, I did think about adding a feature to make,

Tim Benniks: But

Scott Trafford: you know, you know where you go on a website and you see the front view and you see a tilted view and you see but I

Tim Benniks: Exactly. Like I did all that. That was so hard,

Scott Trafford: didn't do that.

Tim Benniks: man.

Scott Trafford: I didn't bother with that for I figured if this isn't going to be in production then it's this is this size and this quality

Everett Zufelt: It can be. They can. invades the feeling.

Tim Benniks: Yeah,

Everett Zufelt: It uh

Tim Benniks: it depends on your who you pitch to though.

Scott Trafford: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: Yeah,

Tim Benniks: Like some some people just need to have that that detail

Everett Zufelt: that's fair. If you're if you're pitching to somebody like Harley,

Scott Trafford: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: mostly.

00:54:07

Everett Zufelt: then it's got to be Rolex.

Tim Benniks: Yeah. Or like Rolex or something like that would never

Everett Zufelt: Yeah. Yeah.

Scott Trafford: Well,

Everett Zufelt: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: fly.

Everett Zufelt: Yeah. Cool. All right. Well, thanks, Scott. Um I'll work with you to make sure we can get this out there, but Tim, it'll be in your hot little hand sometime in the little while.

Tim Benniks: Oh, I'm going to abuse this. Um, can I add my own API key, Scott, or am I

Scott Trafford: Yeah. So, there's a there's an ENV file and you can put your uh your stuff

Tim Benniks: just

Scott Trafford: in there.

Tim Benniks: Oh,

Scott Trafford: Um, and I made I made a demo landing page.

Tim Benniks: nice.

Scott Trafford: So, just for this, but the regular landing page is just um like this here. So, just for the developer version, but if you if you want Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: That

Scott Trafford: Yeah. And if you want me to add any features, let me know.

00:54:55

Scott Trafford: Uh or you can take it and you know do

Everett Zufelt: just do it yourself.

Tim Benniks: You can we pull request?

Everett Zufelt: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: Are you into that or is this more just you build it once and let it

Scott Trafford: whatever.

Everett Zufelt: Uh it's under MACH,

Tim Benniks: go?

Everett Zufelt: so we'll we'll stick our heads together. Like it's not the primary thing we're working on, but also if it's valuable to the community, I don't know why we wouldn't like take Yeah.

Scott Trafford: Yeah. So we we did it to solve a we already have a couple of projects that this is going to be used for and so and then David said he has something you

Tim Benniks: Nice.

Scott Trafford: know commercially he needs it for and obviously yeah this can solve some problems.

Tim Benniks: So I might have one last question.

Scott Trafford: Well,

Tim Benniks: In terms of the data, the JSON that you create around these images, how sophisticated can you make

Scott Trafford: yes. Well, you can do whatever you like,

Tim Benniks: that

Scott Trafford: but um right now it just does a particular um it just does it has a fixed um structure.

00:55:55

Scott Trafford: Um but we could make that a setting too,

Tim Benniks: okay?

Scott Trafford: right?

Tim Benniks: Yeah,

Scott Trafford: That's not difficult.

Tim Benniks: because I can already see that sometimes you want a product that has multiple SKUs or

Scott Trafford: Right.

Tim Benniks: variants and all that stuff.

Scott Trafford: So the the idea was that you leave it in this simple format and then you export it. But if you want to build it directly in a particular format, that's probably a good idea

Everett Zufelt: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: I would probably do that here.

Scott Trafford: too.

Tim Benniks: And if this was actually just a mock SAS, I would put my own API key in the config. I would just have this sit there and use it for every project without spinning it myself.

Scott Trafford: Yeah. Yeah. So, I have this running on a server here at my house and I can generate whatever

Tim Benniks: Yeah, exactly.

Scott Trafford: whenever.

Everett Zufelt: I'm gonna drop off,

Scott Trafford: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: guys, but this is good.

Tim Benniks: Yeah, same.

Everett Zufelt: Thanks, Scott. Thanks,

Scott Trafford: Okay.

Everett Zufelt: Jim.

Tim Benniks: Um,

Scott Trafford: You're welcome.

Tim Benniks: much appreciated. Thanks, Scott. Nice to meet everyone.

Scott Trafford: Okay. Yeah.

Tim Benniks: Cheers.

Scott Trafford: You too. Bye.

Transcription ended after 00:56:53

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